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WAM

SHARJAH GIFTS ARABIC LIBRARY IN POLAND

■ Sheikha Bodour Bint Sultan Al Qasimi, Founder and Honorary President of the Emirates Publishers Association and Founder and Chairperson of the Kalimat Foundation, interacts with children during Sharjah's donation of a portable Arabic library to Marhaba Bolanda, a non-governmental organisation based in Wroclaw, Poland, that focuses primarily on education, offering Arabic and Polish language instruction to members of the Arab community. The Arabic library aims to support children from Arab communities in Poland, reinforcing the importance of giving children living abroad access to books in their mother tongue.

SEE ALSO P5

UAE unveils Naseej to reshape textile sector

ABU DHABI

The UAE has launched Naseej, a national initiative aimed at transforming the country's textile sector through circular economy principles, following directives from President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan.

The initiative seeks to reduce textile waste by shifting the industry away from the traditional "take-make-dispose" model toward one focused on reuse, recycling and resource efficiency.

Developed through a partnership involving the National Projects Office, the Ministry of Economy and Tourism, Emirates Foundation and Tadweer Group, Naseej will serve as a national platform bringing together policymakers, businesses, researchers and communities to coordinate action across the textile value chain.

The initiative comes as textile waste continues to grow in the UAE, with annual volumes estimated at around 220,000 tonnes. To address this challenge, Naseej will focus on five key areas: collection and recycling, public awareness, behavioural research, policies and regulations, and circular business innovation.

Its first public event, "The Fabric of Possibility," will take place at Yas Mall in Abu Dhabi from June 5 to 7. The programme will later expand nationwide, supporting recycling infrastructure, research projects and sustainable textile practices.

— WAM
SEE ALSO P7

IRAN HALTS TALKS WITH US, TIES PEACE DEAL TO LEBANON TRUCE

Demands end to Israeli operations as oil prices surge

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iran has suspended indirect peace talks with the United States, citing Israel's escalating military campaign in Lebanon and demanding an immediate halt to operations there before negotiations can resume, according to Iran's Tasnim news agency.

The move marks a major setback for diplomatic efforts to end the war launched by the US and Israel against Iran in late February and raises fresh concerns over regional stability, global energy supplies and the future of the fragile ceasefire that has been in place since April.

According to Tasnim, Tehran informed mediators that it was halting all exchanges of messages and draft proposals because Israel's offensive in Lebanon had undermined the conditions under which negotiations were taking place.

Immediate end

"Given the continuing crimes of the Zionist regime in Lebanon and considering that Lebanon was one of the preconditions for the ceasefire, the Iranian negotiating team is suspending dialogues and exchange of texts through mediators," the agency reported.

Iran is now demanding an immediate end to Israeli military operations in both Lebanon and Gaza, as well as Israel's with-

GARGASH SLAMS IRAN'S ATTACKS ON KUWAIT

Dr Anwar Mohammed Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, condemned what he described as the continued brutal Iranian attacks on Kuwait, saying the escalation threatens regional security at a time when diplomatic efforts were focused on ending conflicts and restoring stability across the region.

In a post on his X account, Gargash said this escalation reflects a violation of sovereignty and international law, an unacceptable approach that undermines ongoing efforts to steer the region away from cycles of war and crisis. The remarks came amid heightened tensions in the Gulf following a series of missile and drone attacks targeting Kuwait, which Kuwaiti authorities said were intercepted by the country's air defence systems.

"We condemn the continued brutal Iranian attacks against our sisterly State of Kuwait. At a time when the region is witnessing delicate efforts to emerge from the cycle of wars and crises, this escalation and violation of sovereignty and international law reflect an unacceptable approach that undermines efforts to preserve security and stability," Gargash said. "We stand with our sisterly Kuwait wholeheartedly and reaffirm that its security is our security. These grave attacks represent a direct threat to the region and its stability," he added.

— **Khitam Al Amir, Chief News Editor**

drawal from occupied areas in southern Lebanon, before talks can resume.

The development comes as Israel pushes deeper into southern Lebanon and expands operations against the Iran-backed group Hezbollah. Yesterday, the Israeli military warned residents in Beirut's southern suburbs to evacuate ahead of planned strikes, signalling a further escalation of the conflict. At least 3,433 people have been killed and 10,395 have been wounded in Israeli attacks on Lebanon since March 2.

Iranian officials have increasingly tied any broader peace agreement to events in Lebanon,

arguing that a lasting settlement cannot be achieved while Israeli military operations continue there.

Foreign ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei reiterated that position yesterday, saying a ceasefire in Lebanon remained an essential condition for any deal aimed at ending the war.

"We insist that a ceasefire in Lebanon is an essential condition for any deal aimed at ending the war," Baqaei said.

At the same time, tensions between Washington and Tehran remain high. The US military said it carried out what it described as self-defence strikes against Ira-

nian radar and drone-control sites over the weekend following the downing of a US drone. Iran's Revolutionary Guards later said they had targeted an airbase allegedly used to launch the operation.

Financial markets rattled

The diplomatic breakdown rattled financial markets.

Oil prices surged more than five per cent yesterday after reports emerged that Iran had suspended negotiations. Investors also reacted to renewed concerns over the Strait of Hormuz.

Tasnim reported that Iran and its regional allies had discussed fully blocking the Strait of Hormuz and activating other fronts, including the Bab Al Mandab Strait near the entrance to the Red Sea.

While a ceasefire has largely held since April, negotiations have struggled to produce a comprehensive agreement covering Iran's nuclear programme, sanctions relief, the reopening of Hormuz and wider regional security issues.

US President Donald Trump said over the weekend that any future agreement would ensure Iran could not obtain a nuclear weapon.

With fighting continuing in Lebanon and both sides exchanging military strikes, prospects for a breakthrough now appear more uncertain than at any point since the ceasefire took effect.

— with inputs from AFP
SEE ALSO P8, 11

UAE approves new pill for weight loss

Wegovy's once-daily oral version approved for long-term weight management

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE yesterday announced the approval for a new weight loss pill.

The Emirates Drug Establishment (EDE) has approved Wegovy (semaglutide), an oral once-daily treatment indicated for long-term weight management in adults living with obesity or overweight associated with weight-related medical conditions.

Developed by Novo Nordisk, the treatment belongs to the GLP-1 receptor agonist class and supports long-term weight reduction and weight maintenance when used alongside a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity, helping improve health outcomes among eligible patients, EDE stated.

Clinical data also showed the treatment's ability to reduce

the risk of major adverse cardiovascular events in high-risk patients, including cardiovascular death, heart attacks and strokes, the establishment said.

Second country globally

With this approval, the UAE has become the second country globally to authorise the treatment, in a move reflecting the country's leadership's role in adopting advanced therapeutic innovations and enabling early access to them. The country had previously approved the Wegovy injection with similar benefits.

Dr Fatma Al Kaabi, Director General of the Emirates Drug Establishment, said, "Approving the oral formulation of Wegovy (semaglutide) reaffirms the establishment's commitment to promoting the pharmaceutical ecosystem and reinforcing a proactive approach to addressing obesity and overweight challenges, which are among the leading factors associated with chronic diseases, while also supporting the evaluation and approval of innovative therapies in line with internationally recognised scientific standards."

NATION

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BUSINESS

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SPORT

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